past, the rich and the poor, the upwardly mobile and the stagnant is the immediate job the Congress party faces.

Long years hence, when people search for defining moments when communalism and hate were structurally combatted in India, the Bharat Jodo Yatra will stand out prominently. Both a vision and a tapasya, the Yatra has laid the foundations of the reconstruction of a better society. And the teeming multitudes who joined the Yatra are a testament to the fact that there are many dreamers and tapasvis. But there is a caution about dreams, like the hope of eternal youth. Eventually, dreams and hopes do come to fruition. But to truly make them stand the test of time, the torch needs to be passed on to another generation, and yet another. Yes, the Yatra's footprints have been imprinted on the hearts and minds of Indians. But the Yatra must continue, not just by winning elections, but by actualizing fundamental changes in India's economy, society and politics. I pray we are able to do that, both within and without.

For my part, I am satisfied with this knowledge—when our children and grandchildren and great-grandchildren ask us, 'What did you do to save our ancient land when it was under attack?', we can sift through the memories of the Yatra and proudly say, 'We were there with Rahul Gandhi at the Gangotri of new India.' And where Gangotri has been reached, can Sangam be far behind?